

Currently, I make much of my monthly income through brand deals, which include posts on Instagram and Twitter and videos on YouTube. A brand like Google Home or HelloFresh or the sex toy company Adam & Eve will pay me a fee to advertise for their company or product on my accounts (because they know I can reach a wide audience). But brand deals come infrequently, and the pricing is all over the place. Fans also HATE brand deals, and if I post too often, they feel they're being inundated with ads and may unsubscribe or unfollow. I have to maintain a balance—and often turn down lucrative deals that might alienate my fans.

I also work various other freelance writing and acting gigs that cut me small checks to keep the Gaby machine going. (The Gaby machine is fed by cheese.) Payments vary: Some publications pay as much as \$2 a word, and others are \$50 for the whole article. In 2018, I appeared on a sitcom that was eventually sold to Starz. I get speaking fees for talks about LGBTQ issues or personal finance or other topics I'm an "expert" on, so, for example, if I spend five days as a guest at Autostraddle Camp, an annual retreat for queer women, the organization might pay me \$500 for my time. All these little things come together to make me a yearly salary that is then taxed A LOT. (We'll get to that in Chapter 10, "The Tax (Wo)Man.")

Having bits and pieces of jobs that make up your income is common these days. Almost everyone I know is in that situation. Some have full-time jobs and do their side hustle, and others make all the hustles into one "job." Friends of mine babysit because the hours are flexible and because you can sometimes get creative work done while the kid is napping. Other friends drive Lyft or Uber (like my dad does). Or they work for Postmates or sign up for other apps like Fiverr, TaskRabbit, or Handy. My friend Ariana reads people's tarot cards out of her home. She also delivers pizzas. (Apparently pizza places are always looking for drivers, and one perk is if the person doesn't answer the door in time, you as the driver get to keep the pizza, at least according to Ariana's Instagram.) My friend Emily teaches children's yoga.

My sister, on top of her porn marketing job, has been getting really good at selling electronics on eBay. In the last month, she's sold an Alexa, which I got for free at a YouTube convention and never used (paranoia!), and a pair of Beats by